S.N. Pochkhanawala and will thus be a great step forward in the history of Indian banking.'[16]

The *Capital* remarked, 'The decision of the Tata and Central Banks to unite forces is the biggest banking event in India since the inauguration of the Imperial Bank in January 1921. The Central Bank of India has shown enterprise as well as a sporting spirit in acquiring the Tata bank and reensuring the credit of Indian banking…The strength of the two Banks together would make it one of the most prosperous banking institutions in India. The Central Bank will contribute the fruits of high public credit and the Tata Bank the ingredient of large paid-up capital with a strong reserve liability.'[17]

The amalgamation also received praise from the Finance Member, Sir Basil Blackett: 'Among the services which the Central Bank of India has rendered to India, possibly not the least pregnant with results for the future has been its absorption of the Tata Industrial Bank. If this amalgamation can be made, by careful and sound banking, to secure the building up of a single bank stronger than the two banks could have been individually and in separation, an important step will have been taken in the banking sphere to enable banking to keep pace with the industrial progress of India.'[18]

The amalgamation of the TIB was by far the biggest and most colourful feather, in Sorabji's cap. But this amalgamation also brought to the fore P.D. Shamdasani who would harass the Directors and the bank for many years. Shamdasani brought a suit against the Central Bank and the liquidators of the TIB challenging the amalgamation. The suit was dismissed with costs in November 1923 and an appeal filed by Shamdasani also met the same fate the next year. A further appeal in the Privy Council was dismissed with costs in 1929. In 1925, he had filed a suit in the High Court alleging fraud in the balance sheets of December 31, 1923; June 30, 1924; and December 31, 1924. This too was dismissed with costs in 1932, as was the appeal heard later.

As a result of the amalgamation, twelve branches of the TIB came under the control of the Central Bank. The TIB's London branch was closed and subsequently several of the TIB's branches in India were wound up on grounds of poor profitability. The staff of the TIB's branches was mostly European and slowly they were replaced by qualified Indians. The Central Bank by virtue of taking over TIB, had also acquired a branch in Rangoon.